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Key Definitions and Measures

Category 10.0 Acquire, Construct, and Manage Assets

APQC's Process Classification Framework (PCF)® is a reliable and robust framework used by hundreds of leading companies worldwide. The PCF is made up of 13 categories, as seen in Figure 1. This article highlights the definitions for each element for category **10.0 Acquire, Construct, and Manage Assets**, specifically. If you're looking to learn more about the PCF, or download the PCF itself, please visit www.apqc.org/process-frameworks.

APQC's Process Classification Framework (PCF)®



Figure 1

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Structure of the Article

Throughout this article, you will see multiple tables, with different colored headers. They relate to the levels of the PCF (Figure 2).

PCF Levels

LEVEL 1 CATEGORY	11.0 Manage Enterprise Risk, Compliance, Remediation and Resiliency (16437) Represents the highest level of process in the enterprise in general groupings such as manage customer service, supply chain, finance, and human capital.
LEVEL 2 PROCESS GROUP	11.1 Manage Enterprise Risk (17060) Groups of processes that are part of executing a category. Examples include perform after sales repairs, procurement, accounts payable, recruit/source, and develop sales strategy.
LEVEL 3 PROCESS	11.1.3 Manage Business Unit and Function Risk (17462) A single process that may include elements related to variants and rework in addition to the core elements needed to accomplish the process. Examples include invoice customer and develop and manage IT security, privacy, and data protection.
LEVEL 4 ACTIVITY	11.1.3.3 Develop Mitigation Plans for Risks (16458) A key step performed to execute a process. Examples include maintain chart of accounts and develop salary/compensation structure and plan.
LEVEL 5 TASK	11.1.3.3.1 Assess Adequacy of Insurance Coverage (18129) An element of work that goes into executing an activity. They are generally much more fine-grained and may vary widely across industries. Examples include create a business case and obtain funding, and design recognition and reward approaches.

Figure 2

Below is a definition of the different elements and numbers you will see throughout the article.

Element Name

This is the name of the element within the PCF. For example, “Manage supply chain for physical products,” as seen in Figure 3.

4.0 Manage supply chain for physical products (20022)
Performing supply chain activities include planning supply chain, procuring materials and services, and managing logistics.

Figure 3

Hierarchy ID

In the PCF, there are identifying numbers to the left of each process element. These numbers are called hierarchy ID numbers and are used by people to help quickly locate a specific process element. Figure 4 has an example of “4.0.”

4.0	Manage supply chain for physical products (20022)
Performing supply chain activities include planning supply chain, procuring materials and services, and managing logistics.	

Figure 4

Element ID

The numbers to the right of the process elements (20022 in Figure 5) are called process element identification numbers. Each process element in the PCF has a unique five-digit reference number.

4.0	Manage supply chain for physical products	(20022)
Performing supply chain activities include planning supply chain, procuring materials and services, and managing logistics.		

Figure 5

Element Definition

Each element in the cross-industry PCF has a definition associated with it. The definition is designed to provide detail and information around what type of work the element consists of.

In Figure 6, and for all elements in this article, you’ll find the definition directly under the colored heading that contains the name of the process element.

4.0	Manage supply chain for physical products	(20022)
Performing supply chain activities include planning supply chain, procuring materials and services, and managing logistics.		

Figure 6

Outside of the Key Definitions articles (like this one), element definitions can be found in the [Excel version](#) of the PCF, which includes a tab that has definitions for each element.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

A KPI is a specific measure used to gauge a quantifiable component of an organization’s performance at the functional, process, or activity level.

KPIs typically correspond to the organization’s critical success factors and business goals.

Throughout this article, KPIs (when available) will show up in a table underneath the element definition (Figure 7). The KPIs will be listed in the right column and the metric IDs will be listed in the left column.

4.1 Plan for and align supply chain resources (10215)	
Creating strategies for production and materials. Handle the demand for the products of the organization. Develop plans for handling materials. Develop and administer the schedule for master production. Plan for distribution requirements and its constraints by reviewing and assessing distribution policies and performance and by establishing quality standards and procedures.	
Suggested KPIs for Process Group 4.1 Plan for and align supply chain resources (10215)	
Metric ID	KPI
100395	Cash-to-cash cycle time in days
100654	Demand/supply planning costs per \$1,000 revenue

Figure 7

Metric ID

Where KPIs are available, there is a metric ID included for KPIs that can be found in [APQC's Benchmarks on Demand portal](#). The metric ID can be utilized by organizations to search for data related to that metric, such as top, bottom, and median performers.

Throughout this article, KPIs (when available) will show up as a table underneath the element definition (Figure 8). The KPIs will be listed in the right column and the metric IDs will be listed in the left column.

4.1 Plan for and align supply chain resources (10215)	
Creating strategies for production and materials. Handle the demand for the products of the organization. Develop plans for handling materials. Develop and administer the schedule for master production. Plan for distribution requirements and its constraints by reviewing and assessing distribution policies and performance and by establishing quality standards and procedures.	
Suggested KPIs for Process Group 4.1 Plan for and align supply chain resources (10215)	
Metric ID	KPI
100395	Cash-to-cash cycle time in days
100654	Demand/supply planning costs per \$1,000 revenue

Figure 8

Definitions and Suggested Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

10.0 Acquire, Construct, and Manage Assets (19207)

Relating to the design, construction, acquisition, and management of both productive and non-productive assets.

10.1 Plan and acquire assets (10937)

Building and purchasing non-productive assets for the organization. Acquire and construct non-productive assets that are not yielding any income/profits to the business.

Suggested KPI

Metric ID	KPI
100307	Return on fixed assets

10.1.1 Develop property strategy and long term vision (10941)

Strategizing a long-term vision for managing properties. Prepare strategies and a long-term vision for managing purchased/retained properties.

10.1.1.1 Confirm alignment of property requirements with business strategy (10955)

Creating alignment between the requirement of properties and the overall business strategy. This process requires the organization to align the requirement of properties in accordance with its business strategies of the organization.

10.1.1.2 Appraise the external environment (10956)

Evaluating the impact of the external environment. Evaluate the circumstances, objects, events, and aspects surrounding an organization that affects its actions and selections and that recognizes its opportunities and risks.

10.1.1.3 Determine build, buy, or lease decision (10957)

Deciding whether to buy or build properties. Study the market forces about property prices and cost of construction in order to take decisions based on the market research.

10.1.2 Plan facility (10943)

Recognizing the needs of facility users in order to construct a project proposal that meets those needs.

10.1.2.1 Design facility (10958)

Preparing and analyzing different designs for a facility in order to finalize which design will be the most suitable option.

10.1.2.2 Analyze budget (10959)

Evaluating the feasibility of budgets prepared for the construction of facilities.

10.1.2.3 Select property (10960)

Assessing and choosing the appropriate property. Analyze the property requirements. Review the available property options. Finalize the most suitable option.

10.1.2.4 Negotiate terms for facility (10961)

Discussing the terms and conditions of facilities to be occupied according to the business requirements and availability of budgets.

10.1.2.5 Manage construction or modification to building (10962)

Constructing the buildings. Manage renovations according to requirements and demands.

10.1.3 Provide workspace and facilities (10944)

Managing the provision of the workspace and its assets. Arrange an office space with all assets (tables, chairs, computers, admin staff, etc.) according to requirements.

10.1.3.1 Acquire workspace and facilities (10963)

Attaining the office space with all assets (tables, chairs, computers, admin staff, etc.) according to requirements.

10.1.3.2 Change fit/form/function of workspace and facilities (10964)

Modifying the formation of the workspace and its assets. Make necessary changes in an office space with all assets (tables, chairs, computers, admin staff, interior designing, etc.) according to requirements.

10.1.4 Manage facilities operations (10949)

Managing all operational activities of the facility. Manage how each function/business unit works. Support the manufacturing facility to attain organizational goals.

10.1.4.1 Relocate people (10965)

Shifting staff or employees from one place to another place according to changes in business requirements.

10.1.4.2 Relocate material and tools (10966)

Relocating the tools and raw materials. Shift raw or finished material and machines of company from one place to another place according to changes in business requirements.

10.1.4.3 Provide facility access and security (21690)

Ensuring safe, controlled access to organizational facilities by implementing and maintaining physical security protocols, systems, and procedures. This includes issuing and managing access credentials; monitoring entry points; coordinating visitor access; and operating security technologies such as surveillance, alarms, and access-control systems. Establish and enforce policies to protect employees, visitors, assets, and information; respond to security incidents or breaches; and routinely assess the effectiveness of security measures.

10.2 Design and construct assets (21575)

Designing and constructing assets such as machines, tools, factories, etc. Manage steps to acquire assets including managing capital, as well as planning, scheduling, and overseeing acquisition/construction.

10.2.1 Manage capital program for assets (19209)

Producing and maintaining a planning schedule and a financial plan to purchase or manufacture assets. Determine the investment plan, monitor capital, and secure the necessary financing in order to realize completion of the program.

10.2.1.1 Define capital investment plan (19210)

Establishing what funds will be invested in the construction of assets for the advancement of established business objectives.

10.2.1.2 Monitor capital program (19211)

Monitoring plans on capital projects. Capital projects can be purchasing buildings, lands, etc.

10.2.1.3 Secure construction financing (19212)

Acquiring the loans needed to construct necessary assets.

10.2.2 Design and plan asset construction (20139)

Outlining the steps and strategies needed to construct assets. Verify that all regulations are adhered to and that all permissions have been granted. Organize and plan for resources to complete construction.

10.2.2.1 Develop construction strategy (19220)

Developing a strategy to perform asset construction. Assure that timelines, regulations, and resources are on task and on budget.

10.2.2.2 Perform construction performance management (11276)

Managing the construction process to ensure that activities are on task, on budget, and are being performed with safety and quality in mind.

10.2.2.3 Obtain construction permissions (19221)

Gathering the required permits for construction from the proper jurisdiction. This may include inspections during and after construction to verify that the new asset meets all national, regional, and local codes.

10.2.2.4 Design assets (19222)

Designing assets to meet organizational needs as well as ensuring that the asset adheres to all national, regional, and local construction codes.

10.2.2.5 Plan construction resources (19223)

Determining what resources will need to be acquired in order to carry out construction. Plan when, where, and how resources will be used. Determine the length of time resources will be utilized.

10.2.3 Schedule and perform construction work (19229)

Arranging a timetable for which to perform construction work. Schedule resources to contract assets for new or replacement assets. Reschedule or redesign assets if needed.

10.2.3.1 Schedule construction work (19230)

Defining a timetable for which to execute the construction of the asset.

10.2.3.2 Obtain resources (19231)

Gathering resources needed to complete all construction work. Verify that all resources have the proper training and skills to perform the work.

10.2.3.3 Construct new assets (19232)

Building new assets necessary for the organization. Be aware of any construction codes and permits that need to be addressed.

10.2.3.4 Augment existing assets (19233)

Modifying existing assets to align with the changing needs of the organization. Be aware of any construction codes and permits that need to be addressed.

10.2.3.5 Renew/Replace assets (19234)

Determining the need to replace existing assets. Be aware of any construction codes and permits that need to be addressed.

10.2.4 Manage asset construction (19224)

Overseeing the performance and quality of work. Assure that records are maintained throughout the construction process. Adhere to all safety, security, and access regulations set forth by the organization and all government standards.

10.2.4.1 Monitor work performance (19225)

Monitoring construction to ensure that all regulatory laws are being adhered to, that all work is being performed in a timely manner, and that quality assurance is met at all steps of the construction process.

10.2.4.2 Undertake construction quality control (19226)

Implementing a checks and balances system to verify that the construction was performed correctly. Rework when errors are found.

10.2.4.3 Create work and asset records (19227)

Implementing records to include all construction work that has been performed. Include all new or modified construction, and any construction or regulatory issues that might have occurred.

10.2.4.4 Manage safety, security, and access to sites (19228)

Ensuring that safety, security, and access is maintained. Provide a workplace that meets and exceeds all local, state, and federal guidelines. Provide security and access to the building site as set forth by safety and organizational guidelines.

10.2.4.5 Schedule and perform commissioning (21689)

Scheduling and performing commissioning activities to verify that constructed assets operate as intended, meet specified requirements, and are ready for handover, use, or operational acceptance.

10.3 Maintain assets (19238)

Preserving assets through the planning, managing, and performance of preventative, routine, and critical maintenance work.

10.3.1 Plan asset maintenance (19239)

Ensuring that necessary resources are available and tasks are prioritized accordingly through planning. Provide strategies and policies that identify tasks that need to be completed, and the resources necessary to fulfill those tasks.

10.3.1.1 Develop maintenance strategies (19240)

Creating goals and agendas to better realize the success of the maintenance policies that have been put into place.

10.3.1.2 Analyze assets and predict maintenance requirements (10967)

Evaluating assets in order to project future requirements for maintenance. Evaluate the present working condition of assets. Determine the future maintenance requirements of assets.

10.3.1.3 Specify maintenance policies (19241)

Communicating policies in regards to asset maintenance. Provide a clear set of procedures and policies that outline what will be involved in the maintenance process.

10.3.1.4 Integrate preventive maintenance into operations schedule (10968)

Devising a methodology and procedure for assimilating the works of planned maintenance into the schedule scheme for the processing of finished products that utilizes the same machinery.

10.3.1.5 Identify work management tasks & priorities (19242)

Identifying the steps needed for asset maintenance. List out the those tasks that are involved in completing this process. Prioritize the tasks that are created.

10.3.1.6 Conduct resource planning (19243)

Analyzing workload needs in relation to asset maintenance and plan resources around those needs.

10.3.1.7 Create work plans (19244)

Creating procedures on how to maintain assets.

10.3.2 Manage asset maintenance (19245)

Ensuring that asset maintenance is conducted in a timely manner and successfully. Schedule work with the required resources with an eye on quality control and safety. Verify that contracted maintenance meets performance targets.

10.3.2.1 Schedule maintenance work (19246)

Defining a timetable for which to execute the maintenance of the asset.

10.3.2.2 Obtain required resources (19247)

Gathering resources needed to complete all maintenance work. Verify that all resources have the proper training and skills to perform the work.

10.3.2.3 Undertake quality control (19248)

Implementing a checks and balances system to verify that the maintenance was performed correctly. Rework when errors are found.

10.3.2.4 Update work and asset records (19249)

Modifying existing maintenance records to include all new work that has been performed, what assets were serviced, and any issues that might have arisen.

10.3.2.5 Manage maintenance work safety (19250)

Assuring that all safety laws and regulations are being implemented and followed. Align practices with regulatory bureaus such as OSHA, EHS, and ISO.

10.3.2.6 Define maintenance performance targets (19251)

Outlining what should be achieved through predictive indicators with regard to performing maintenance. This could include the length of time it takes to perform routine maintenance or how often unplanned maintenance feasibly occur.

10.3.2.7 Monitor maintenance performance against targets/contracts (19252)

Following set performance targets, monitor and gage the success of the organization in meeting those targets.

10.3.3 Perform asset maintenance (19253)

Engaging in all aspects of asset maintenance. Ensure that all assets are functioning properly and to all specified codes and regulations where applicable. Maintenance includes all preventative, routine, and corrective activates.

10.3.3.1 Perform preventative asset maintenance (10947)

Performing prophylactic maintenance in an effort to avoid corrective or unplanned repairs.

10.3.3.2 Perform routine asset maintenance (19254)

Carrying out required maintenance to continue upkeep of equipment or assets.

10.3.3.3 Perform corrective asset maintenance and repairs (19255)

Repairing or correcting faults that occur with an asset. This could be a break or other repairable damage.

10.3.3.4 Identify unplanned maintenance requirements (19256)

Realizing potential or current problems with assets that would require unplanned maintenance. Unplanned maintenance is a repair or change that needs to be made that is not preventative or routine.

10.3.3.5 Perform unplanned maintenance and repairs (19257)

Performing repairs that occur outside of normal routine or preventative maintenance.

10.4 Manage asset end-of-life (21576)

Managing the disposition of assets at their end-of-life. End-of-life for an asset may be due to obsolescence, replacement, excess capacity, or disrepair among other potential factors. Steps may include decommissioning, disassembly, recycling, etc. Tracking and reporting may also be appropriate for some or all asset types due to law, regulation, or social/environmental responsibility.

10.4.1 Develop exit strategy (10952)

Creating a strategy for managing asset exits.

10.4.1.1 Monitor useful life of assets (18592)

Monitoring assets against their planned useful life. Each asset may have specific criteria that indicate their usability. This may include time-based, maintenance history, capacity planning, etc.

10.4.1.2 Perform cost vs. benefit analysis for replacement (21577)

Cost/benefit analysis of assets to determine retention or end-of-life. Evaluating asset total lifecycle cost against other factors such as repair/refurbishment, replacement, and alternate solutions.

10.4.2 Decommission productive assets (19258)

Retiring assets that are no longer viable to the business. Decommission assets that are no longer in working order, are out of date, or whose maintenance exceeds the cost of replacement.

10.4.3 Perform sale or trade (10953)

Performing the sale of assets. Achieve and complete the sale process. Deliver the end product to the customers.

10.4.4 Manage take-back centers (12717)

Managing locations where end-of-life assets are evaluated for decommissioning, disassembly, recycling, etc.

10.4.5 Dismantle assets (21579)

Dismantling an asset into manageable parts. The parts may follow different dispositions, such as resale, reuse, recycle, etc.

10.4.6 Track parts (21580)

Tracking the disposition of all parts from end-of-life assets. Tracking should provide an audit trail to include source, rationale for disposition, and destination.

10.4.7 Recycle parts (21581)

Recycling parts in accordance with legal, regulatory, and social/environmental responsibilities.

10.4.8 Ship hazardous material (12721)

Planning, conducting, and tracking shipment of hazardous materials.

10.4.9 Provide government reporting (12722)

Preparing and distributing government reports.

10.4.10 Perform abandonment (21582)

Planning and performing abandonment activities. Whether facilities or equipment, ensure assets to be abandoned are safe, secure, and meet all legal, regulatory, and social/environmental responsibilities.

10.4.10.1 Demolish and secure (13131)

Demolishing and securing asset and resulting parts/debris.

10.4.10.2 Restore site (13132)

Performing remediation or restoration activities.

10.4.10.3 Monitor site for duration of time required by regulators (19465)

Managing and reporting site status. Align efforts to all legal, regulatory and social/environmental responsibilities.

10.4.10.4 Prepare handover to new operator or landowner (13133)

Supporting handover to new operator or landowner. Include proper documentation on asset history and current state to enable orderly transition.

10.4.11 Perform waste and hazardous goods management (21583)

Planning and performing waste and hazardous goods management. In compliance with all legal, regulatory, and social/environmental requirements, plan, document, and conduct hazardous material handling, disposal, and reporting.

10.4.11.1 Maintain material safety data sheets (12180)

Preparing material safety sheets. Capture material safety records to properly apply handling and disposal requirements.

10.4.11.2 Maintain awareness of and communicate regulatory requirements (12181)

Understanding and communicating hazardous material regulatory requirements.

10.4.11.3 Maintain hazardous material handling and disposal (12182)

Planning, overseeing, and tracking hazardous material handling and disposal.

10.4.11.4 Manage compliance audits (12183)

Planning, supporting, and documenting hazardous material audits.

10.4.11.5 Recognize need to disposition hazardous materials/waste (12184)

Identifying and establishing approaches to dispose of hazardous materials/waste.

10.4.11.6 Determine disposition and associated processing (12185)

Evaluating hazardous materials and waste for appropriate disposition. Apply requirements and initiate disposition activities.

10.4.11.7 Manage disposition, disposal, reprocessing activities (12186)

Performing disposition, disposal, and reprocessing activities.

10.4.11.8 Manage documentation and reporting (12187)

Documenting and reporting disposition, disposal, and reprocessing activities.

About APQC's Process Classification Framework (PCF)[®]

The Framework for Process Improvement

Experience shows that the potential of benchmarking to drive dramatic improvement lies squarely in making out-of-the-box comparisons and searching for insights not typically found within intra-industry paradigms. To enable this beneficial benchmarking, the PCF serves as a high-level, industry-neutral enterprise process model that allows organizations to see their business processes from a cross-industry viewpoint.

The PCF enables organizations to understand their inner workings from a horizontal process perspective, rather than a vertical functional viewpoint. The PCF does not list all processes within a specific organization, and every process listed in the framework is not present in every organization.

Originally created in 1992 by APQC and a group of members, the framework has experienced more than twenty years of creative use by thousands of organizations worldwide. The PCF is supported by APQC's Open Standards Benchmarking research. It is continuously enhanced as APQC's Open Standards Benchmarking team further develops definitions, processes, and measures. Please visit APQC's web site periodically for updates. The PCF is available for organizations of all industries and sizes at no charge by visiting <http://www.apqc.org/pcf>.

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